

Islamic University of Technology (IUT)

Islamiat

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What do you know about Fasting???

- Ibadaats
 - Purification
 - Prayer/Salah
 - Zakah
 - - Islamic Economics/ Economic System in Islam
 - Fasting/Sawm
 - Hajj

- A general overview of Fasting
- Benefits of fasting
- Rules regarding fasting
- Utilizing this special blessings

A general overview of Fasting

- self-control is indispensable for all human beings regardless of religion, creed and color. Any sane person can realize that if everyone lives whimsically according to their desire, the whole mankind will vanish in a short period of time or there will be chaos everywhere. Therefore Islam puts utmost emphasis on self control and provided for that a number of mechanisms and methods. Allah says:

“Is one who was dead and we granted him life, and provided him with light that enables him to move among the people, equal to one in total darkness from which he can never exit?” (6:122)

- Fasting is a practical exercise of **self control**. Due to its practical implication it is one of the pillar of Islam. Quensequetly it helps Muslims acquire **Taqwa (awareness of Allah)**. Allah says:

“O you who believe, fasting is decreed for you, as it was decreed for those before you, that ye may (learn) self-restraint”.

2:183

Reflection of the verse:

- Fasting is not only prescribed for the Ummah of Prophet Muhammad (PBUH), but it was, with little variations in types, for previous prophets too. So it remained among the key worships of Islam in its final form, abrogating all the previous forms.
- The positive impacts of the fasting in its last form for the Ummah of Prophet Muhammad sm is manifested on Muslims life personally, psychologically, behaviorally and socially.

Fasting and the month of Ramadan.....

- In this month the Quran was revealed.
- In this month the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) started inviting people to Islam.
- furthermore, counting the month by moon sighting also alludes to the scientific aspect of Allah's power and no one has any interference in it.
- Fasting in Ramadan also boosts the Muslims brotherhood and sense of unity rather than fasting in different months or leaving it to Muslims to chose by themselves.

Definition of Fasting and its philosophical basis:

To abstain from all that nullify fasting from dawn to dusk for the sake of Allah with proper intention.

- The Nullifiers include any kind of eating and drinking, intercourse, ejaculation etc..... (كلوا واشربوا)
- The **bottom-line here is to abstain from the tow desires which are the most influential desires in human beings.** Therefore, whoever manage to control these two desires in the course of Ramadan, will be able to control other desires and lusts quite easily. **Moreover**, they will be able to fulfill their these two desires more wisely after Ramadan i.e. avoiding gluttony and any other malpractices in intercourse.

(Fastin= a Month Long Training Period)

- Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) said in this regard:
“Whoever can guarantee (the chastity of) what is between his two jaw-bones and what is between his two legs, I guarantee Paradise for him.”

(Bukhari)

- No means can help Muslims to control his tongue as it can in Ramadan. Because, when someone is always well-fed and not hungry makes the body and mind so strong. Consequently it becomes difficult for him to control his tongue and tongue is the tool for expressing whatever men have in mind. Therefore if the mind is not imbued with Islamic ethos, it will manifest in their tongue, hands, legs and in behavior and deeds. So controlling the mind by abstaining from desire of eating and drinking makes men avoid the wrong path and follow the right one.

- Prophet Muhammad sm said in this regard:

“if one does not abandon from falsehood and other actions like it,
God has no need that one should abandon one's food and drink”.

(Bukhari).

If any one fails to elevate to that status of faith, then his fasting is simply futile. As the Prophet said:

"There are people who fast and get nothing from their fast **except hunger**, and there are those who pray and get nothing from their prayer but a **sleepless night**". (A sound Hadith according to Targhib)

- **Physical benefits of fasting:**

A number of studies suggest that fasting has many positive impacts on human body including digestion process, rapid consumption of sugar in blood, maintaining a healthy balance of weight.

(Autophagy)

Japanese cell biologist Yoshinori Ohsumi won the Nobel Prize in Medicine in 2016 for his research on how cells recycle and renew their content, a process called autophagy. Fasting activates autophagy, which helps slow down the aging process and has a positive impact on cell renewal.

Significance: Autophagy is a highly conserved eukaryotic cellular recycling process. Through the degradation of cytoplasmic organelles, proteins, and macromolecules, and the recycling of the breakdown products, autophagy plays important roles in cell survival and maintenance.

- **Physical benefits of fasting:**

Besides, even in Ramadan, it is scientifically proven that little amount of consumption is better than huge amount of consumption. In other words, eating little at the time of breaking the fast and at the time of *suhur* is better than filling the whole stomach. That was the practice of Prophet Muhammad (PBUH). Allah says:

”And whatsoever the Messenger gives you, take it, and whatsoever he forbids you, abstain from it“.

59:07

Some of the Sunnah of Ramadan:

- Having the Suhur. The Prophet Muhammad sm said: “You should have suhur for there is **blessing** in suhur”. (Muttafaq Alaihi)

Moreover, due to suhur Muslims wake up before Fajr providing them to pray *Tahajjud* and other extra duas as well as performing fajr after having suhur.

- Making dua at the time of Ifter for the chance of acceptance of the dua is very high.

- Performing the **Tarawih salat**. It is an unique opportunity to listen to the Quran and do some extra dua and dhikr.
 - **Performing I'tikaf** at the last ten days. It provides Muslims the opportunity to seclude themselves for complete devotion and to be isolated from all kinds of **worldly affairs**.
 - **Recitation of the whole Quran at least once**. Jibrael A. used to teach Quran the Prophet Muhammad sm in Ramadan.
 - Spending **extra charity** for the sake of Allah, particularly the *sadaqatul Fitr* on behalf of every individuals. The Prophet Muhammad sm said that
- “Sadaqatul Fitr is prescribed for Muslims to compensate the mistakes of fasting and provide sustenance for the poor”.

(Nasaee)

Acts That Nullify the Fast & Require Makeup & Expiation

- Acts that invalidate the fast and require a makeup along with expiation only relate to the current Ramadan fasts.
- If done deliberately, by **one's own free will**, and without a valid reason while fasting a current Ramadan fast, the following acts invalidate the fast and require a makeup along with expiation:
 1. eating or drinking something that humans would normally consume and this consummation nourishes, medicates or pleases the body in some way.
 2. actual sexual intercourse, in the front or rear private part, regardless if one ejaculated or not
 3. swallowing the saliva of one's spouse

What is the Expiation?

- The expiation is to fast sixty consecutive days in the year without any interruption.
- The only exceptions to this rule are if one is menstruating or in a state of lochia (post-natal bleeding)
- If one is genuinely unable to perform the sixty consecutive fasts based on reasonable surety, then one must either:
 - a. feed the same sixty, poor people to their fill for two meals, or
 - b. feed one poor person to his fill for two meals a day for sixty days, or
 - c. give sixty poor people half a sa' of wheat (or similar food grains) or its monetary value, or
 - d. give sixty poor people a sa' of dates (or similar food grains) or its monetary value, or
 - e. give one poor person either food for sixty days.

Acts That Vitate the Fast & Require Make Up But Do Not Require Expiation

It also includes any makeup fast one vitiated while trying to make it up.

The Mouth & Throat:

- eating or drinking
- eating or drinking because one thought Maghrib entered but Maghrib did not enter
- eating or drinking because one doubted that Fajr not entered but Fajr really did enter
- eating or drinking forgetfully and thereafter thinking that the fast is broken, to deliberately eat and drink again

رفع عن أمتي الخطأ والنسيان. “To Err is Human”

- swallowing what is between the teeth, on the condition that it is the size of a chickpea or bigger
- swallowing a pebble or other items that people wouldn't typically eat
- swallowing water by accident when gargling for wudu or ghusl (with the exception of water that remains in the mouth—see next category)
- swallowing blood that exits from the gums and preponderates over the saliva
- swallowing toothpaste or mouthwash

- deliberately swallowing vomit that reaches a mouthful
- deliberately vomiting a mouthful, regardless if one swallows it or not
- vomiting and thereafter thinking that the fast is broken, to deliberately vomit again
- smoke that enters the throat by one's doing, on the condition one's body doesn't benefit from it
- kissing that causes one to ejaculate, on the condition one did not swallow the other's saliva

The Private Parts:

- engaging in sexual intercourse because one still thinks Fajr has not entered but it really has entered.
- engaging in sexual intercourse forgetfully and thereafter thinking that the fast is broken, to deliberately have sexual intercourse again.
- entering a suppository into the anus
- entering something dry into the anus and it completely disappears inside the body
- entering something wet or oiled into the anus, even if it does not completely disappear inside of the body

The Nose:

- water used to clean the nose for wudu or ghusl reaches the throat or the brain
- inhaling medicine into the nostrils
- inhaling smoke by one's doing, on the condition one's body doesn't benefit from it

The Body in General:

- touching that causes one to ejaculate (this includes masturbation)
- applying medicine to an open abdominal or head wound and it reaches the stomach or the brain.







What do you know about Hajj????

- Hajj : A general overview
- Historical background
- Spiritual dimensions of Hajj
- Types of Hajj
- Prohibited deeds in Hajj
- Methods of performing Hajj

Hajj : A general overview

Hajj represents a couple of core characteristics of Islam. They are:

- It represents Muslims divine servitude to Islam. As long the Prophet sm ordered Muslims to perform Hajj with maintaining some different activities including Tawaf, **Say'ee**, throwing stones etc. **Whether these made sense to them or not, they implemented prophet's order without question.** That is one of the highest form of submissions to Islam.

Allah says:

”And whatsoever the Messenger gives you, take it, and whatsoever he forbids you, abstain from it“.

59:07

- Hajj is a means to connect the Muslims to their Father Ibrahim A. as the rituals of Hajj and moving around the Ka'ba', which was built by him, remind Muslims of Ibrahim and his story in Makkah.
- Hajj is also a sign of Muslim greater brotherhood and strengthens the sense of **Ummatic concerns irrespective of nationality, color and wealth**. Allah says:

“O mankind! Lo! We have created you male and female, and have made you nations and tribes that ye may know one another. Lo! the noblest of you, in the sight of Allah, is the best in conduct. Lo! Allah is Knower, Aware”.

49:13

- Hajj revives special feelings and consciousness in Muslims. It inspires Muslims to be more compassionate toward other Muslims.
- It reminds Muslims of the Prophet sm and his companions and their persecutions in the early era of Islam.
- It inspire the feeling of special devotion to Allah.
- It help Muslims to be detached from worldly life and to be focused on the life hereafter.

Hajj: A Historical perspective

Allah commanded Prophet Ibraheem (may Allah's peace be upon him) to leave his second wife Haajar and their newly born son Ismail (may Allah's peace be upon him) alone in the uninhabited valley of Bakkah (Makkah). Narrated Ibn Abbas (may Allah be pleased with him): Ibraheem brought her and her son Ismail while she was suckling him, to a place near the Ka'bah under a tree on the spot of Zamzam, at the highest place in the mosque. During those days there was nobody in Makkah, nor was there any water. So he made them sit over there and placed near them a leather bag containing some dates, and a small water-skin containing some water, and set out homeward.

Ismail's mother followed him saying, 'O Ibraheem! Where are you going, leaving us in this valley where there is no person whose company we may enjoy, nor is there anything (to enjoy)?' She repeated that to him many times, but he did not look back at her. Then she asked him, 'Has Allah ordered you to do so?' He said, 'Yes.' She said, 'Then He will not neglect us', and returned while Ibraheem proceeded onwards, and on reaching the Thaniya where they could not see him, he faced the Ka'bah, and raising both hands, invoked Allah saying the following prayers:

"Oh our Lord! I have made some of my offspring to dwell in a valley with no cultivation, by your Sacred House (the Ka'bah at Makkah); in order, Oh our Lord, that they may offer prayers perfectly, so fill some hearts among men with love towards them, and (Oh Allah) provide them with fruits so that they may give thanks." 14: 37

Ismail brought the stones and Ibraheem was building, and when the walls became high, Ismail brought this stone and put it for Ibraheem who stood over it and carried on building, while Ismail was handing him the stones, and both of them were saying, 'O our Lord! Accept (this service) from us, Verily, You are the All-Hearing, the All-Knowing'. "

(Bukhari)

Allah says:

“And (remember) when We prepared for Abraham the place of the (holy) House, saying: Ascribe thou no thing as partner unto Me, and purify My House for those who make the round (thereof) and those who stand and those who bow and make prostration”.

22:26

Hajr-al-Aswad (Black Stone): A special stone was placed in its eastern corner to mark the starting point for the circling of the Ka'bah. This stone according to the Prophet's explanation was originally shining white in colour when it was brought down from Paradise. However, due to the sins of man it changed to its present colour of black, hence the name Hajr-al-Aswad (the Black Stone). Narrated Ibn Abbas (may Allah be pleased with him), Allah's Messenger said, "The black stone descended from Paradise whiter than milk, but the sins of the descendants of Adam made it black.“ (Ahmad and Tirmiji)

Hajj as a pillar of Islam:

Hajj is the 5th pillar of Islam. It is obligatory for those Muslims who can afford to make the journey to Makkah. It is a once in a lifetime obligation. It is performed from the 8th to the 13th of Dhul-Hijja, which is the 12th month of the Hijra (lunar) calendar. Allah instructed Prophet Ibraheem:

“And proclaim among men the Pilgrimage: they will come to you on foot and on every lean camel, coming from every remote path”. 22:27

Allah also says:

And Hajj (pilgrimage to Makkah) to the House (Ka'bah) is a duty that mankind owes to Allah, those who can afford the expenses (for one's conveyance, provision and residence); and whoever disbelieves (i.e. denies Hajj, then he is a disbeliever of Allah), then Allah stands not in need of any of the Alamin (mankind and jinn)."

3:97

- **Hajj Wipes off Past Sins** Abu Hurairah (may Allah be pleased with him) reported that the Prophet said: "He who performs Hajj for Allah's pleasure and avoids all lewdness and sins will return after Hajj free from all sins as he was the day his mother gave birth to him."
- (Bukhari and Muslim)

• **Who should perform Hajj?**

- Allah does not wish to make things difficult for the Muslims. Apart from the duty being fardh (compulsory) only once in a lifetime, there are certain other conditions that have to be met for one to be 'eligible':
- 1. To be a Muslim 2. To have reached puberty 3. To be of sound mind 4. To be free (not a slave) 5. To have the financial means 6. To possess the physical means 7. To have a Mahram (for women)

Types of Hajj

There are three types or methods of performing Hajj. All three methods fulfill all the Islamic requirements for the Hajj.

- The one that most people perform is called Hajj **Tamattu (Enjoy)**. This is the Hajj the Prophet instructed his companions to perform. This is Hajj joined with Umrah with two separate niy'at {**One Travel_Two Niy'at_Two Ihram_Umrah & Hajj**}.
- The other two methods are: Hajj **Qiran- (Doing Together)** (Umrah and Hajj, with one niyah) {**One Travel_One Niy'at_One Ihram_Umrah & Hajj**}.
- Hajj **Ifrad (single/Alone)** : the Hajj only {**One Travel_One Niy'at_One Ihram_Only Hajj**}.
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Benefits of Umrah

Ibn 'Abbas reported that the Prophet sm said, "An 'Umrah in the month of Ramadaan is equal (in reward) to performing a Hajj." (This does not, however, remove from one the obligation of performing the obligatory Hajj)."

(Ahmad and Ibn Majah)

Abu Hurairah reported that the Prophet said, "From one 'Umrah to the next is an atonement for any sins committed in between, and the reward for an accepted Hajj is nothing but Paradise."

(Bukhari and Muslim)

Meeqaat:

- A Muslim who intends to go to Makkah is not allowed to pass the Meeqaat without donning the Ihraam. There are five zones as mentioned in the Hadith below:

It was narrated from 'Aisha: Rasulullah ﷺ designated **Dhul-Hulaifah** as the Meeqaat for the people of Al-Madinah, **Al-Juhfah** for the people of Syria and Egypt, **Dhat 'Irq** for the people of Iraq, and **Yalamlam** for the people of Yemen.

(Muslim)

The Pillars (Arkan) of Hajj The pillars of Hajj are the rites that are mandatory for the validity and completion of the Hajj. 1. Ihraam (with niyah). 2. Standing at Arafat. 3. Tawaaf-al-Ifadah (Tawaaf for Hajj). 4. Sa'ee for Hajj.

The Wajib (Obligatory) acts of Hajj: The obligatory rites of Hajj are the rites that if omitted require the pilgrim to offer a Fidyah (expiation). This is a sacrifice commonly known as *dam*. Many scholars rule that if these rites are omitted intentionally (premeditated) without any valid reason, then the Hajj is incomplete. 1. Ihraam at the meqaat. 2. Being at Arafat until sunset. 3. To spend the night (or part of) in Muzdalifah. 4. To *ramy* (cast pebbles) at the jamr'at. 5. To shave the head or cut the hair. 6. To spend the nights of Tashreeq in Mina. 7. To perform Tawaaf-al-Wadaa.

- **The things which are prohibited in ihraam are things which a person must refrain from doing because of being in ihraam. They are:**

1. Shaving the hair of the head
 2. Using perfume after entering ihraam, whether on one's clothes or body, or in one's food or when washing the deceased muhram or in any way whatsoever. Using perfume is forbidden in ihraam
- 3. Intercourse

4. Touching one's wife with desire, because this comes under the general meaning of the phrase "he should not have sexual relations (with his wife)", and because it is not permissible for the muhrim (person in ihraam) to get married or to propose marriage – so it is more likely that it is not permissible for him to touch his wife with desire.
5. Killing game (hunting)

- 6 – A prohibition which applies exclusively to men is wearing shirts, hooded robes, trousers, turbans and leather slippers. But he (peace and blessings of Allaah be upon him) made an exception for one who cannot find an izaar (lower garment or waist wrapper), who may wear trousers, and one who cannot find sandals, who may wear leather slippers.
7. – One of the prohibitions of ihraam that applies only to women is nikaab refers to a veil that covers the face and leaves the eyes uncovered, because the Prophet (peace and blessings of Allaah be upon him) forbade that. A similar prohibition applies to the burqa'. When a woman enters ihraam, she should not wear a nikaab or burqa'. It is prescribed for her to leave her face uncovered except when a non-mahram man passes by her, when she must cover her face and it does not matter if this cover touches her face.

Issues related to women and Hajj:

Mahram: The obligation of Hajj is the same for women as it is for men. However, a woman has to meet one additional requirement for eligibility, namely to have a Mahram. A mahram for any woman is her husband or any male she is prohibited from marrying forever because of a relationship resulting from either blood, marriage, or breast-feeding. Examples of mahram are brothers, fathers, and uncles. Brothers-in-law or cousins are NOT mahram).

Ihraam and Clothing: Unlike men, the Ihraam clothes for women are their normal clothes and can be of any colour. No attractive clothes, perfume or make-up should be worn during Hajj or while going to the mosque or in the company of non-mahram men. Other points regarding the clothes: 1. The material itself must not be decorative. 2. It must be thick enough to be completely opaque. 3. It must be loose enough as not to make clear the shape of her body. 4. It must not resemble the dress of men. 5. Or resemble the dress of disbelieving women. 6. It must not be ostentatious

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